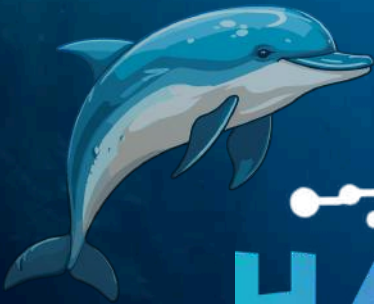




Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University
(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)
NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



HACKATHON RULEBOOK



Powered By



Sponsored By



Ed Tech Partner





CONTENT



S. NO.	CONTENT	PAGE NO.
1	About HackOcean 2026	4
2	Challenge Format and Rounds	5-6
3	Team Formation Guidelines	7
4	Registration Process	8
5	General Guidelines	9
6	Project Development Rules	10
7	GitHub Monitoring and Submission Protocol	11
8	Final Submission Requirements	12



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA

Deemed University

(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)

NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



CONTENT



9	Evaluation Criteria	13-15
10	Code of Conduct	16
11	Disqualification Rules	17
12	FAQs	18-19
13	Official Communication Channels	20
14	Contact Information	21



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University
(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)
NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



ABOUT HACKOCEAN 2026



HackOcean 2026 is a National-Level Frontend Development Challenge organized by the Digital Learning Group (DLG), MITS Gwalior, in collaboration with Madhav Institute of Technology & Science (MITS), Gwalior.

Join bright and aspiring innovators from across India to tackle real-world problems, showcase your technical and creative skills, and build impactful solutions that matter – all from the comfort of your screen.

HackOcean offers a national platform to compete for prizes, earn national recognition, and connect with like-minded tech enthusiasts from across the country. Every participant walks away with hands-on experience and a digital certificate, while finalists additionally ship a live, deployed project with a public GitHub repository – regardless of where they place.

Dive in. Build deep. Ship bold



CHALLENGE FORMAT & ROUNDS



HackOcean 2026 is structured across two distinct rounds, designed to test not just how fast you can code, but how well you can think, plan, and present your solution before you ever ship it.

Round 1 – IGNITION (PPT Submission Round)

- Duration:

04 July 2026, 12:00 PM IST – 22 July 2026, 06:00 PM IST

- Format:

Presentation (PPT) – no coding required

- Registration Fee:

₹49 (Solo) / ₹89 (Duo) / ₹139 (Trio) / ₹179 (Squad)

- Task:

Choose any ONE of the three given problem statements (same ones featured in Round 2) and prepare your solution using the Official HackOcean PPT Template.

Shortlisting: Top 50 teams will qualify for Round 2.



Round 2 – DEEP OCEAN (Grand Finale)

- Date:
24 July 2026
- Time:
12:00 PM – 11:59 PM IST (12 Hours)
- Team Size:
1–4 Members
- Challenge
Build a complete multi-page frontend solution based on the same problem statement selected in Round 1.
- Problem Statements
 - ◆ PS 01 – ABYSS | Deep Sea Exploration Co.
Design a responsive landing page for a fictional deep-sea exploration company.
 - ◆ PS 02 – REEF | Ocean Conservation Platform
Create an engaging landing page promoting ocean conservation and volunteer participation.
 - ◆ PS 03 – DeepSea Guardian | AI-Powered Deep Ocean Pollution & Biodiversity Monitoring
Develop an AI-powered platform for monitoring ocean pollution, marine biodiversity, and environmental risks.
- Requirements
 - Build a complete multi-page frontend.
 - Dummy/Mock API data is allowed.
 - No backend required.
 - Live deployment is mandatory before submission



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University

(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)

NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



TEAM FORMATION GUIDELINES



- Solo – 1 participant
- Duo – 2 participants
- Trio – 3 participants
- Squad – 4 participants
- No exceptions, no team changes after registration closes.
- Each participant can only be part of one team.
- One team member must be designated as the point of contact for all communications.



REGISTRATION PROCESS

- **Visit Unstop Platform :**

Registration for HackOcean 2026 is hosted on Unstop.

- **Form a Team :**

Solo, duo, trio, or squad, as per your preference.

- **Fill in Details :**

Team name, member info, contact details.

- **Pay Registration Fee:**

₹49 (Solo) / ₹89 (Duo) / ₹139 (Trio) / ₹179 (Squad). Fee is non-refundable and covers both rounds.

- **Submit on Unstop:**

Before the Round 1 deadline.

- **Receive Confirmation :**

Official guidelines + WhatsApp community link shared via email/Unstop.



GENERAL GUIDELINES

- **Read all rules carefully** – this is the preliminary guideline; further details shared via WhatsApp.
- Plagiarism or copying an existing website's design / pre-built UI = instant disqualification.
- Internet may be used only for reference and research purposes.
- AI tools (Cursor, v0, Copilot, ChatGPT, and more) are fully allowed – zero restrictions, but usage must be disclosed.
- A participant can only be part of one team.
- All code must be developed during the official challenge hours of each round.
- Team composition cannot be changed after registration closes.
- Each team selects one Round 2 theme; the solution must align with it throughout.
- The judges' decision is final and binding.



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University

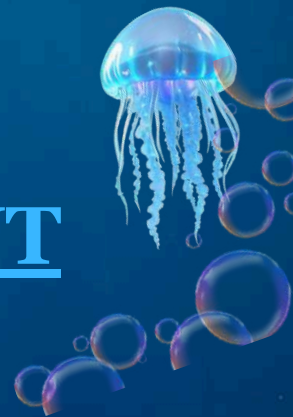
(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)

NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



PROJECT DEVELOPMENT RULES



- Round 1 presentations must be built only on the Official PPT Template, with the Team Name clearly mentioned on the first slide.
- Round 2 development work may only start after the official start time on Finale Day (24 July, 12:00 PM IST).
- GitHub repositories for Round 2 will be monitored, including commit timestamps, to ensure no pre-built work is submitted as original.
- Repository must be made public at the time of submission.
- Pre-existing/template codebases are allowed only for non-functional UI skeletons, and must be clearly mentioned in the README.md.



GITHUB MONITORING & SUBMISSION PROTOCOL



- **Round 1:** Presentation (PPT) submitted via the official form before the deadline.
- **Round 2:** Project submitted via public GitHub repo + live deployed link (Vercel/Netlify/GitHub Pages).
- Evaluation through internal panels reviewing the PPT (Round 1) and repo, live link, and documentation (Round 2).
- Communication via: WhatsApp Community, Official Mails, Unstop Notices.
- Participants are free to use any language, framework, or tech stack for the frontend build in Round 2.



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University

(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)
NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



FINAL SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS



Round 1 – Ignition:

- Presentation (PPT) prepared using the Official HackOcean PPT Template
- Team Name mentioned clearly on the first slide
- Must include: Problem Statement, Proposed Solution, Key Benefits, Tech Stack, High-Level System Architecture Diagram
- Submitted before the deadline via the form

Round 2 – Deep Ocean:

- Complete multi-page frontend solution for the chosen problem statement
- Mobile-responsive design
- SEO basics on every page
- Hardcoded/dummy data is fine – no backend required
- Public GitHub repo + live deployed link, both submitted via the form



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University
(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)
NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



EVALUATION CRITERIA ROUND 1 (50 MARKS).



S. NO.	CRITERIA	MARKS
1	Problem Understanding	12
2	Solution Approach & Innovation	12
3	UI/UX Wireframe & Planning	10
4	Presentation Quality	10
5	Creativity & Feasibility	6

Only the Top 50 Teams (by Round 1 score) will be shortlisted for Round 2.



EVALUATION CRITERIA ROUND 2 (50 MARKS).



S. NO.	CRITERIA	MARKS
1	Problem Solving	12
2	Performance & Core Web Vitals	10
3	UI/UX & Responsiveness	10
4	SEO & Accessibility	6
5	Visual Design & Creativity	8
6	Innovation	4



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University
(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)
NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



Bonus Points (Discretionary):

- Scalability & Deployment Potential
- Social Impact (sustainability, inclusivity, public good)
- Open Source Contribution (clean, well-documented code)

Note:

- All projects are evaluated only after the respective round ends. Judges' decisions are final, non negotiable, and binding.



CODE OF CONDUCT



Do's :

- Respect team members and other participants.
- Maintain online decorum.
- Disclose use of AI and third-party tools where asked.

Don't :

- Use copied designs or pre-built projects/presentations.
- Misrepresent work or contributors.
- Spam or disrupt any communication channels.



DISQUALIFICATION RULES



Participants may be disqualified if:

- Submission (PPT or project) is submitted after the deadline.
- Submission contains plagiarized/copied design, presentation, or code.
- Team violates the Code of Conduct.
- Multiple team registrations by a single participant.
- Submission contains offensive/inappropriate content.
- Team includes an organizer, volunteer, judge, or sponsor.
- Round 2 build does not match the problem statement submitted in Round 1.



FAQs



Q1. Can I participate solo?

Yes, solo participation is allowed.

Q2. What is the registration fee?

Registration fee is applicable from Round 1 itself – ₹49 (Solo) / ₹89 (Duo) / ₹139 (Trio) / ₹179 (Squad). Fee is non-refundable and covers both rounds.

Q3. Can I use ChatGPT, Copilot, Cursor, or v0?

Yes, AI tools are fully allowed at every stage - zero restrictions.

Q4. Will certificates be given?

Yes, a digital certificate is given to every participant who submits a Round 1 presentation, regardless of placement.



FAQs



Q5. Is a live deployment link mandatory?

It's mandatory only for Round 2 – a public GitHub repo and a live deployed link (Vercel/Netlify/GitHub Pages) must both be submitted. Round 1 requires only the PPT

Q6. Can I change my team after registration?

No, team modifications are not allowed after registration closes.

Q7. Can I switch my problem statement between Round 1 and Round 2?

No, the problem statement chosen and pitched in Round 1 must be the one built in Round 2.

Q8. How will Round 2 be evaluated?

Based on the submitted GitHub repo, live link, and documentation as per the judging criteria above (50 marks)



Madhav Institute of Technology & Science, Gwalior (M.P.), INDIA
Deemed University

(Declared under Distinct Category by Ministry of Education, Government of India)
NAAC ACCREDITED WITH A++ GRADE

Digital Learning
Group



OFFICIAL COMMUNICATION CHANNELS



Unstop Link-

REGISTER NOW

DLG Instagram-

INSTAGRAM

DLG LinkedIn Page-

LINKEDIN